

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 915

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A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Hobart L. "Coach" Powell, Sr., of Jonesborough.

WHEREAS, we were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Hobart L. "Coach" Powell, Sr., of Jonesborough; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Powell was an exemplary public servant and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for his fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, Hobart Powell was born on December 22, 1933, to James and Agnes Walker Powell; he attended Sulphur Springs High School, where he excelled in athletics and academics; and

WHEREAS, he then attended Lincoln Memorial University, where he played basketball and baseball; after graduating in 1955, Hobart Powell married the love of his life, Phyllis Henry Bowman, and was drafted by the New York Yankees; and

WHEREAS, his professional baseball career was interrupted after two years when he was drafted into the U.S. Army; and

WHEREAS, following his military service, Hobart Powell coached men's basketball in Branford, Florida, for two years, leading the Branford High School Buccaneers to a 27-4 record and a trip to the state semifinals; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Powell and his wife then returned to Tennessee, settling in Jonesborough to raise their family; he coached men's basketball and baseball at Jonesboro High School for eight years, men's basketball at Sulphur Springs High School for two years, and varsity men's basketball at David Crockett High School for three years; and

WHEREAS, he then acquired a master's degree in education from East Tennessee State University and transitioned to working in administration in the Washington County School System; he first served as principal at Asbury Elementary School and then assistant principal and principal at David Crockett High School, before becoming principal of Fall Branch Elementary School and, ultimately, Jonesborough Elementary School; and

WHEREAS, in retirement, Hobart Powell spent twenty-two years working part time with his friends in the Pro Shop at Pine Oaks Golf Course; and

WHEREAS, Coach Powell's career ambition was to be a coach; he cherished teaching young men how to work hard, prepare, and compete to the best of their abilities; and

WHEREAS, Hobart Powell was a member of the Rhea Lodge No. 47, where he was raised to the sublime degree of Master Mason in 1956; he is also a member of the Lincoln Memorial University Sports Hall of Fame and the David Crockett High School Sports Hall of Fame; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Powell was an avid golfer, lifetime New York Yankees fan, and dedicated supporter of East Tennessee State University athletics and David Crockett High School; and

WHEREAS, deeply devoted to his family, Hobart Powell always endeavored to remain true to family values of the highest order; and

WHEREAS, he will be sadly mourned but fondly remembered by his three children, Lori Powell (Fritz) Thumler, Hobie Powell, and Jim Powell; four grandchildren, Abbie (Cliff) Thumler-Robins, Alexander Thumler, Walker (Olivia) Powell, and Caroline Powell; great-grandson, Shiloh Thumler-Robins; and a host of nieces, nephews, cousins, friends and family; and

WHEREAS, in addition to his parents, he was preceded in death by his beloved wife of sixty-three years, Phyllis Bowman Powell, and his brothers, John Powell and Jean Powell; and

WHEREAS, Hobart Powell leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Hobart L. "Coach" Powell, Sr., reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we extend our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Coach Powell.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.